

CV 5101

Modeling, Uncertainty, and Data for Engineers

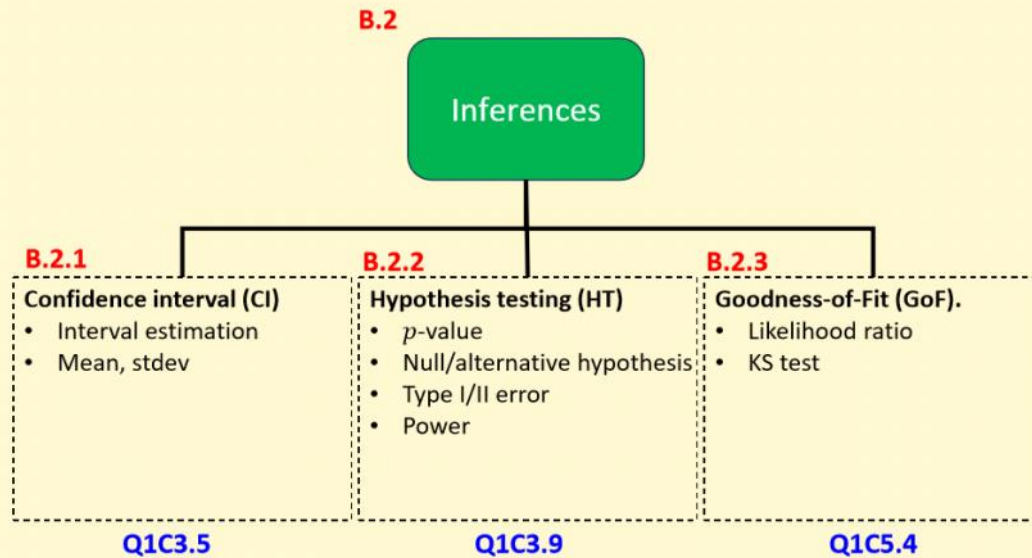
(July – Nov 2026)

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Parameter estimation

- Next few class:
 - Estimation: MoM, MLE
 - Inference: Confidence interval (CI)
 - Inference: Hypothesis testing (HT)
 - Goodness of fit (GoF): χ^2 , KS

Module Overview



Flow

- Bias and precision
- Confidence interval
 - Of mean
 - Of variance
- Example

Bias and precision

J: how close dart throws are to bulls-eye

• Accuracy/bias:

- How close/far, on an average, are the darts from bulls-eye?
- Unbiasedness, neutrality

J: how close dart throws are to each other

• Precision:

- How close are the darts to each other?
- Consistency, repeatable

High Accuracy
High Precision



Low Accuracy
High Precision



High Accuracy
Low Precision



Low Accuracy
Low Precision

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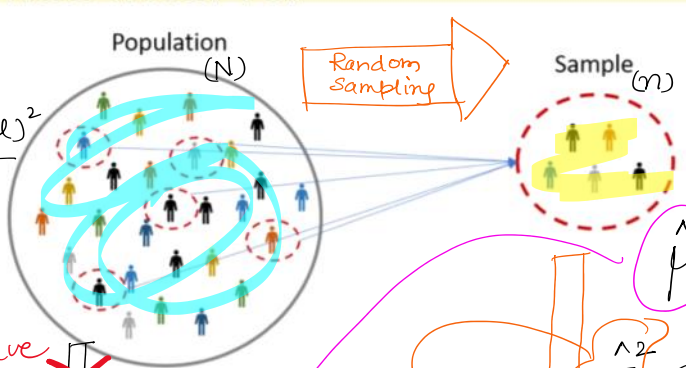
Confidence interval

e.g., election polls,
Mechanical prop.

$$\mu = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^N x_i}{N}$$

$$\sigma^2 = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^N (x_i - \mu)^2}{N}$$

POPULATION STATISTIC



can't observe directly!

Population parameters
(μ , σ^2)

INFERENCE

SAMPLE STASTIC

$$\hat{\mu} = \bar{X}_n = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^n x_i}{n}$$

$$\hat{\sigma}^2 = s^2 = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^n (x_i - \hat{\mu})^2}{n-1}$$

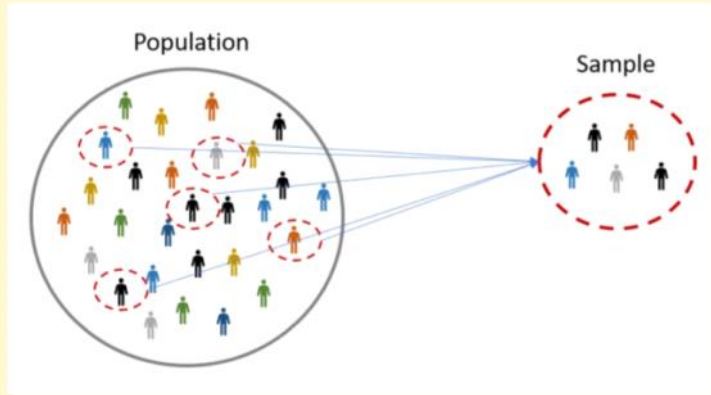
CLT

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Confidence interval

- Issue with the point estimate, $\hat{\mu}$

Each new sample results in a different estimate of μ, σ



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Central Limit Theorem (CLT)

- Let $X_1, X_2, \dots, X_n$ be a sequence of i.i.d. random variables having a distribution with mean μ and var. σ^2 . If Y is the sample average of X_i 's.

Find μ_Y and σ_Y^2

$$Y = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^n X_i}{n} = \frac{X_1 + X_2 + \dots + X_n}{n} = \frac{1}{n} X_1 + \frac{1}{n} X_2 + \dots + \frac{1}{n} X_n$$

$$\Rightarrow \mu_Y = \frac{1}{n} \mu_1 + \frac{1}{n} \mu_2 + \dots + \frac{1}{n} \mu_n = \frac{1}{n} \mu + \frac{1}{n} \mu + \dots + \frac{1}{n} \mu$$

$$\Rightarrow \mu_Y = \mu \rightarrow \text{population}$$

$$\sigma_Y^2 = \left(\frac{1}{n}\right)^2 \sigma_1^2 + \left(\frac{1}{n}\right)^2 \sigma_2^2 + \dots + \left(\frac{1}{n}\right)^2 \sigma_n^2$$

$$= \frac{1}{n^2} \sigma^2 + \frac{1}{n^2} \sigma^2 + \dots + \frac{1}{n^2} \sigma^2 = \frac{\sigma^2}{n} \Rightarrow \sigma_Y = \frac{\sigma}{\sqrt{n}}$$

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Confidence interval

- Basic idea:

Best estimate of μ is $\bar{X}$

Population Mean μ $\rightarrow$ Random Sample's mean $\bar{X}$

But in reality, $\bar{X}$ is never equal to μ .

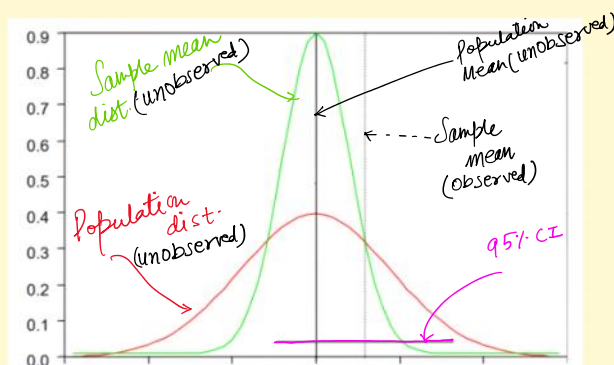
- No way to tell how close they are.

$\Rightarrow$ Using confidence interval, we define the probability that an interval covers μ .

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Confidence interval for μ

- Basic idea:



$\rightarrow$ Std. Normal, Z

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Confidence interval for μ

- $\bar{x}$: sample mean
- n : sample size
- α : significance level
- $100(1 - \alpha)\%$: confidence level

$x \rightarrow$ observation
 $x - \mu \rightarrow$ centralized $\Rightarrow$ mean = 0
 $(x - \mu) / \sigma \rightarrow$ Normalized $\Rightarrow$ stdev = 1

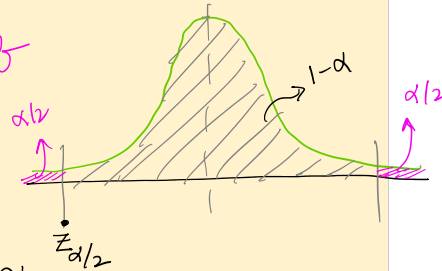
$100(1 - \alpha)\%$ confidence interval of



• α : significance level

• $100(1 - \alpha)\%$: confidence level

$100(1 - \alpha)\%$ confidence interval of μ is given by



$$Pr\left(-z_{\alpha/2} \leq \frac{\bar{x} - \mu}{\sigma/\sqrt{n}} \leq z_{\alpha/2}\right) = 1 - \alpha$$

$$\Rightarrow Pr\left(\bar{x} - z_{\alpha/2} \frac{\sigma}{\sqrt{n}} \leq \mu \leq \bar{x} + z_{\alpha/2} \frac{\sigma}{\sqrt{n}}\right) = 1 - \alpha$$

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Example-1 on CI

• $n = 10$ measurements of impact energy (J) are as follows:

• 64.1, 64.7, 64.5, 64.6, 64.5, 64.3, 64.6, 64.8, 64.2, 64.3

• The sample mean is $\bar{x} = 64.46$

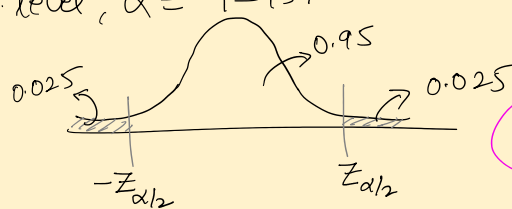
• Assume impact energy is normally distributed with $\sigma = 1$ J

• Find a 95% CI for μ , the mean impact energy

95% C.I.

Confidence level = 95%

sig. level, $\alpha = 1 - 95\% = 5\% \Rightarrow \alpha/2 = 2.5\%$



$\Rightarrow z_{\alpha/2} = 1.96$

$$63.84 \leq \mu \leq 65.08$$

$$64.46 - 1.96 \times \frac{1}{\sqrt{10}} \leq \mu \leq 64.46 + 1.96 \times \frac{1}{\sqrt{10}}$$

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99% C.I.

$$z_{\alpha/2} = z_{0.005} = 2.575$$

$$63.64 \leq \mu \leq 65.27$$

Standard Normal Probabilities

Z-table

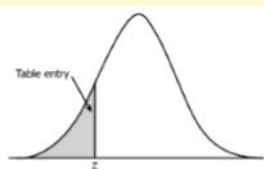


Table entry for z is the area under the standard normal curve to the left of z .

z	.00	.01	.02	.03	.04	.05	.06	.07	.08	.09
-3.4	.0003	.0003	.0003	.0003	.0003	.0003	.0003	.0003	.0003	.0002
-3.3	.0005	.0005	.0005	.0004	.0004	.0004	.0004	.0004	.0004	.0003
-3.2	.0007	.0007	.0006	.0006	.0006	.0006	.0006	.0005	.0005	.0005
-3.1	.0010	.0009	.0009	.0009	.0008	.0008	.0008	.0008	.0007	.0007
-3.0	.0013	.0013	.0013	.0012	.0012	.0011	.0011	.0011	.0010	.0010
-2.9	.0019	.0018	.0018	.0017	.0016	.0016	.0015	.0015	.0014	.0014
-2.8	.0026	.0025	.0024	.0023	.0023	.0022	.0021	.0021	.0020	.0019
-2.7	.0035	.0034	.0033	.0032	.0031	.0030	.0029	.0028	.0027	.0026
-2.6	.0047	.0045	.0044	.0043	.0041	.0040	.0039	.0038	.0037	.0036
-2.5	.0062	.0060	.0059	.0057	.0055	.0054	.0052	.0051	.0049	.0048
-2.4	.0082	.0080	.0078	.0075	.0073	.0071	.0069	.0068	.0066	.0064
-2.3	.0107	.0104	.0102	.0099	.0096	.0094	.0091	.0089	.0087	.0084
-2.2	.0139	.0136	.0132	.0129	.0125	.0122	.0119	.0116	.0113	.0110
-2.1	.0179	.0174	.0170	.0166	.0162	.0158	.0154	.0150	.0146	.0143
-2.0	.0228	.0222	.0217	.0212	.0207	.0202	.0197	.0192	.0188	.0183
-1.9	.0287	.0281	.0274	.0268	.0262	.0256	.0250	.0244	.0239	.0233
-1.8	.0359	.0351	.0344	.0336	.0329	.0322	.0314	.0307	.0301	.0294
-1.7	.0446	.0436	.0427	.0418	.0409	.0401	.0392	.0384	.0375	.0367
-1.6	.0548	.0537	.0526	.0516	.0505	.0495	.0485	.0475	.0465	.0455
-1.5	.0668	.0655	.0643	.0630	.0618	.0606	.0594	.0582	.0571	.0559
-1.4	.0808	.0793	.0778	.0764	.0749	.0735	.0721	.0708	.0694	.0681
-1.3	.0968	.0951	.0934	.0918	.0901	.0885	.0869	.0853	.0838	.0823
-1.2	.1151	.1131	.1112	.1093	.1075	.1056	.1038	.1020	.1003	.0985
-1.1	.1357	.1335	.1314	.1292	.1271	.1251	.1230	.1210	.1190	.1170
-1.0	.1587	.1562	.1539	.1515	.1492	.1469	.1446	.1423	.1401	.1379
-0.9	.1841	.1814	.1788	.1762	.1736	.1711	.1685	.1660	.1635	.1611
-0.8	.2119	.2090	.2061	.2033	.2005	.1977	.1949	.1922	.1894	.1867
-0.7	.2420	.2389	.2358	.2327	.2296	.2266	.2236	.2206	.2177	.2148
-0.6	.2743	.2709	.2676	.2643	.2611	.2578	.2546	.2514	.2483	.2451
-0.5	.3085	.3050	.3015	.2981	.2946	.2912	.2877	.2843	.2810	.2776
-0.4	.3446	.3409	.3372	.3336	.3300	.3264	.3228	.3192	.3156	.3121
-0.3	.3821	.3783	.3745	.3707	.3669	.3632	.3594	.3557	.3520	.3483
-0.2	.4207	.4168	.4129	.4090	.4052	.4013	.3974	.3936	.3897	.3859
-0.1	.4602	.4562	.4522	.4483	.4443	.4404	.4364	.4325	.4286	.4247
-0.0	.5000	.4960	.4920	.4880	.4840	.4801	.4761	.4721	.4681	.4641

Interpretation of a CI

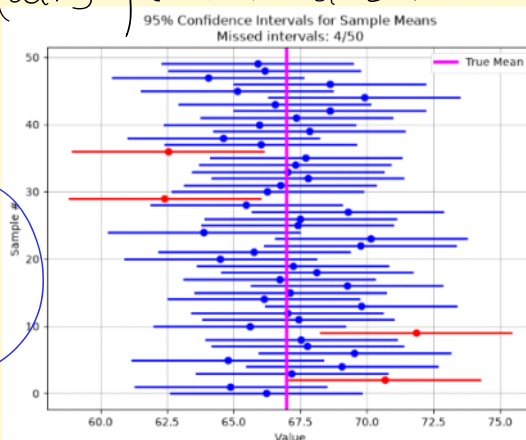
- The true mean μ is within this CI with a probability of 95%.
~~Tempting BUT incorrect, as μ is a constant.~~ (POP MEAN)
- Each CI, either contains μ or it does NOT.

$$Pr(\mu \in CI) = \text{either } 0 \text{ or } 1$$

What is 95%?

→ If we repeat 'sampling' say 100 times, on an average, 95 times the CI will cover μ .

CONFIDENCE



Choice of sample size

- For a target error in the length of interval

For a $100(1-\alpha)\%$ confidence that the error $|\bar{x} - \mu|$ will NOT exceed a specific amount E ,

100(1- α)% confidence that the true mean μ will NOT exceed a specific amount E ,
What is the sample size

$$\bar{x} - Z_{\alpha/2} \frac{\sigma}{\sqrt{n}} \leq \mu \leq \bar{x} + Z_{\alpha/2} \frac{\sigma}{\sqrt{n}}$$

for $Z_{\alpha/2} \frac{\sigma}{\sqrt{n}} \leq E \Rightarrow n \geq \left(\frac{Z_{\alpha/2} \sigma}{E} \right)^2$

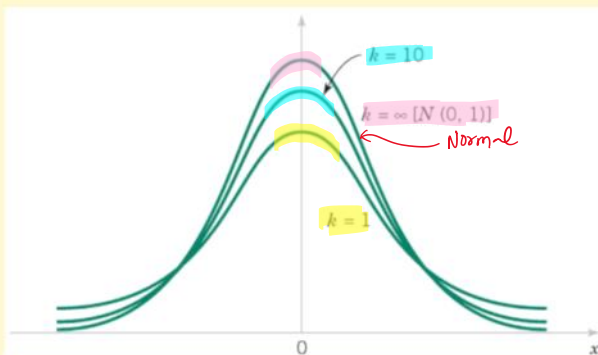
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Small sample sizes

When n is small,
Sample mean has thicker tail than the Normal Distribution.

$\Rightarrow$ t-distribution captures it using dof

$$\Pr\left(\bar{x} - t_{\alpha/2, n-1} \frac{s}{\sqrt{n}} \leq \mu \leq \bar{x} + t_{\alpha/2, n-1} \frac{s}{\sqrt{n}}\right) = 1 - \alpha$$



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$$\bar{x} = \frac{x_1 + x_2 + \dots + x_n}{n}$$

$$s^2 = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^n (x_i - \bar{x})^2}{n-1}$$

Known and Unknown Variance (CI for μ)

Pop Var. σ^2	Sample Size n	Test Statistic & Sampling Dist.	Std. Error SE	C.I.	Assumption
Known (σ given)	Small ($n < 30$)	$Z = \frac{\bar{X} - \mu}{\sigma/\sqrt{n}}$ $\sim N(0,1)$	$\frac{\sigma}{\sqrt{n}}$	$\left[\bar{x} - z_{\alpha/2} \frac{\sigma}{\sqrt{n}}, \bar{x} + z_{\alpha/2} \frac{\sigma}{\sqrt{n}} \right]$	Population must be normally distributed .
Known (σ given)	Large ($n \geq 30$)				Population dist. can be arbitrary (valid by CLT).
Unknown (σ estimated by s)	Small ($n < 30$)	$T = \frac{\bar{X} - \mu}{s/\sqrt{n}}$ $\sim t_{n-1}$	$\frac{s}{\sqrt{n}}$	$\left[\bar{x} - t_{\alpha/2, n-1} \frac{s}{\sqrt{n}}, \bar{x} + t_{\alpha/2, n-1} \frac{s}{\sqrt{n}} \right]$	Population must be normal ; necessary for $\frac{\bar{X} - \mu}{s/\sqrt{n}} \sim t_{n-1}$
Unknown (σ estimated by s)	Large ($n \geq 30$)	$Z \approx \frac{\bar{X} - \mu}{s/\sqrt{n}}$ $\sim N(0,1)$	$\frac{s}{\sqrt{n}}$	$\left[\bar{x} - z_{\alpha/2} \frac{s}{\sqrt{n}}, \bar{x} + z_{\alpha/2} \frac{s}{\sqrt{n}} \right]$	Population dist. can be arbitrary (by CLT); $s \approx \sigma$ by Law of Large Numbers .

C.L.T. $\frac{\bar{X} - \mu}{\sigma/\sqrt{n}} \xrightarrow{d} N(0,1)$ as $n \rightarrow \infty$

Law of Large Numbers $s \xrightarrow{p} \sigma$ as $n \rightarrow \infty$

Confidence interval for σ^2

$$Z_1^2 + Z_2^2 + \dots + Z_k^2$$

- Let $X_1, X_2, \dots, X_n$ be a **random sample** from a distribution with mean μ and stdev σ . Let s^2 be the **sample variance**.

$\frac{(n-1)s^2}{\sigma^2}$ follows χ^2 with $(n-1)$ degrees of freedom.

A $100(1-\alpha)\%$ C.I. for σ^2

$$Pr \left[\chi_{1-\frac{\alpha}{2}, n-1}^2 \leq \frac{(n-1)s^2}{\sigma^2} \leq \chi_{\frac{\alpha}{2}, n-1}^2 \right] = 1-\alpha$$

$$Pr \left[\frac{(n-1)s^2}{\chi_{\frac{\alpha}{2}, n-1}^2} \leq \sigma^2 \leq \frac{(n-1)s^2}{\chi_{1-\frac{\alpha}{2}, n-1}^2} \right] = 1-\alpha$$

Example-3 on CI for σ^2

- $n = 10$ measurements of concrete cylinder compressive strength (in MPa) are recorded as follows:

32.1, 33.4, 31.8, 32.5, 33.0, 32.7, 31.9, 33.2, 32.4, 32.0

- The sample variance is calculated as $s^2 = 0.33 \text{ MPa}^2$
- Assuming compressive strength is normally distributed, find a **95% confidence interval** for:
- The population variance σ^2
- The population standard deviation σ

$$0.1556 \text{ MPa}^2 \leq \sigma^2 \leq 1.0963 \text{ MPa}^2$$

$$\Rightarrow 0.394 \text{ MPa} \leq \sigma \leq 1.047 \text{ MPa}$$

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df	$\chi^2_{.995}$	$\chi^2_{.990}$	$\chi^2_{.975}$	$\chi^2_{.950}$	$\chi^2_{.900}$	$\chi^2_{.100}$	$\chi^2_{.050}$	$\chi^2_{.025}$	$\chi^2_{.010}$	$\chi^2_{.005}$
1	0.000	0.000	0.001	0.004	0.016	2.706	3.841	5.024	6.635	7.879
2	0.010	0.020	0.051	0.103	0.211	4.605	5.991	7.378	9.210	10.597
3	0.072	0.115	0.216	0.352	0.584	6.251	7.815	9.348	11.345	12.838
4	0.207	0.297	0.484	0.711	1.064	7.779	9.488	11.143	13.277	14.860
5	0.412	0.554	0.831	1.145	1.610	9.236	11.070	12.833	15.086	16.750
6	0.676	0.872	1.237	1.635	2.204	10.645	12.592	14.449	16.812	18.548
7	0.989	1.239	1.690	2.167	2.833	12.017	14.067	16.013	18.475	20.278
8	1.344	1.646	2.180	2.733	3.490	13.362	15.507	17.535	20.090	21.955
9	1.735	2.088	2.700	3.325	4.168	14.684	16.919	19.023	21.666	23.589
10	2.156	2.558	3.247	3.940	4.865	15.987	18.307	20.483	23.209	25.188
11	2.603	3.053	3.816	4.575	5.578	17.275	19.675	21.920	24.725	26.757
12	3.074	3.571	4.404	5.226	6.304	18.549	21.026	23.337	26.217	28.300
13	3.565	4.107	5.009	5.892	7.042	19.812	22.362	24.736	27.688	29.819
14	4.075	4.660	5.629	6.571	7.790	21.064	23.685	26.119	29.141	31.319
15	4.601	5.229	6.262	7.261	8.547	22.307	24.996	27.488	30.578	32.801
16	5.142	5.812	6.908	7.962	9.312	23.542	26.296	28.845	32.000	34.267
17	5.697	6.408	7.564	8.672	10.085	24.769	27.587	30.191	33.409	35.718
18	6.265	7.015	8.231	9.390	10.865	25.989	28.869	31.526	34.805	37.156
19	6.844	7.633	8.907	10.117	11.651	27.204	30.144	32.852	36.191	38.582
20	7.434	8.260	9.591	10.851	12.443	28.412	31.410	34.170	37.566	39.997
21	8.034	8.897	10.283	11.591	13.240	29.615	32.671	35.479	38.932	41.401
22	8.643	9.542	10.982	12.338	14.041	30.813	33.924	36.781	40.289	42.796
23	9.260	10.196	11.689	13.091	14.848	32.007	35.172	38.076	41.638	44.181
24	9.886	10.856	12.401	13.848	15.659	33.196	36.415	39.364	42.980	45.559
25	10.520	11.524	13.120	14.611	16.473	34.382	37.652	40.646	44.314	46.928
26	11.160	12.198	13.844	15.379	17.292	35.563	38.885	41.923	45.642	48.290
27	11.808	12.879	14.573	16.151	18.114	36.741	40.113	43.195	46.963	49.645
28	12.461	13.565	15.308	16.928	18.939	37.916	41.337	44.461	48.278	50.993
29	13.121	14.256	16.047	17.708	19.768	39.087	42.557	45.722	49.588	52.336
30	13.787	14.953	16.791	18.493	20.599	40.256	43.773	46.979	50.892	53.672
40	20.707	22.164	24.433	26.509	29.051	51.805	55.758	59.342	63.691	66.766
50	27.991	29.707	32.357	34.764	37.689	63.167	67.505	71.420	76.154	79.490
60	35.534	37.485	40.482	43.188	46.459	74.397	79.082	83.298	88.379	91.952
70	43.275	45.442	48.758	51.739	55.329	85.527	90.531	95.023	100.425	104.215
80	51.172	53.540	57.153	60.391	64.278	96.578	101.879	106.629	112.329	116.321
90	59.196	61.754	65.647	69.126	73.291	107.565	113.145	118.136	124.116	128.299
100	67.328	70.065	74.222	77.929	82.358	118.498	124.342	129.561	135.807	140.169

Next

- Type I and Type II error
- Hypothesis testing of mean

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Questions, comments,
or concerns?

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